

POWER PLAYERS

HRV SOLAR

Entrepreneur: Prasanth Sakhamuri

Investors: Aureos India, SIDBI

IDEA: Lead-free and highest energy producing solar panels

ATTERO RECYCLING

Entrepreneurs: Nitin Gupta, Rohan Gupta

Investors: DFJ India, NEA-IndoUS

IDEA: Recycling plant for e-waste and precious metal refining

GREEN INFRA

Entrepreneur: Sunil Jain

Investor: IDFC PE funds

IDEA: Concentrated solar power generation and wind power

SUNBORNE ENERGY HOLDINGS LLC

Entrepreneurs: Yogi Goswami, Hemant Taneja, James Abraham

Investor: General Catalyst Partners

IDEA: Concentrated solar power generation model

HUSK POWER SYSTEMS

Entrepreneurs: Gyanesh Pandey (in picture), Ratnesh Yadav

Investors: Israeli, US PE funds

IDEA: Solar-based lighting systems

ASTONFIELD RENEWABLE RESOURCES LIMITED

Entrepreneurs: Saurabh Sen, Ameet Shah

Investor: Own capital

IDEA: Solar photovoltaic plants with high efficiency inverters

ACME TELE POWER

Entrepreneur: Manoj Upadhyay

Investors: Monsoon India Inflection and Jackson Heights Investments

IDEA: Green towers, telecom shelters for power saving at sites

GREENKO PLC

Entrepreneurs: Anil Kumar Chalamalasetty, Mahesh Kolli

Investor: Global Environment Fund

IDEA: Run-of-river hydro and biomass-fired plants

plants and wind turbines, converting municipal waste into power, and recycling water. There was a time when people like Nitin or Kala, let alone an Acumen Fund, would not have given even a second thought to making money from such ventures. There was neither any market in the country nor was there any government support. Yes, there were activities in this area but they were mostly by big businesses who could afford to take risks.

Cut to circa 2010, and the cleantech space is brimming with start-ups jostling for space in what promises to be the next big wave. According to a just released Assocham-Deloitte Study, clean energy is one of the three sectors emerging as the most favoured

Government initiatives. Driving this is the potential of growth, the demand for energy in the context of 12 per cent power deficit and the imperative of cleantech to manage emission level requirements that will come up in the future.

Clearly, the rush has got government support. "We have already identified a potential of near about 1,00,000 MW from wind, biomass and small hydro sources in the country," says Farooq Abdullah, Minister for New and Renewable Energy. India's own renewable energy investment grew 12 per cent in 2008 with an investment of \$3.7 billion in a single year. The Government would provide concessional import tax of 5 per cent on machinery and equipment for solar



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FAROOQ ABDULLAH, Minister for New and Renewable Energy

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LAWRENCE SPINELLI, President, Overseas Private Investment Corporation



ones for PE investors in India. Indian companies managed to rake in \$315 million in venture capital and PE investments in 2009, down from \$595 million in 2008, thanks to the meltdown which saw global investment in cleantech slump by about 6 per cent to approximately \$145 billion. There were 26 deals in 2009, three more than in the previous year. Analysts expect a flow of over \$200 million in 2010. Kalpana Jain, senior director, Deloitte, sees a likely increase in capital inflows into the Indian cleantech space in 2010, primarily in clean energy, water and waste management—given the potential of the market and

power projects. Solar equipment and parts for rotor blades used in wind turbines have also been spared from tax on production. Ground source heat pumps used to tap geo-thermal energy have been exempted from basic customs duty and special additional duty. Lawrence Spinelli, president of Overseas Private Investment Corporation, says, "With increased government attention and favourable demand-supply scenario, India has all the key parameters in place to top-rank as a cleantech investment market."

Not surprisingly, these fiscal and policy packages are luring the likes of Gyanesh Pandey and